

UNDERSTANDING FINANCIAL INDEPENDENCE

In its truest sense, financial independence means freedom. No, I'm not talking about some vague notion of *financial freedom*. I don't believe anyone is ever free from their finances. You'll always have to spend time and attention on your finances, whether they're good or bad. Your money is yours to manage, and it's impossible to manage anything that you don't stay connected to often. We've seen that millionaires never outgrow the act of budgeting or setting financial goals, so stop thinking about financial independence as some point in the future when you don't have to think about money anymore. Get over it. You'll *always* have to think about money. The goal is to make those thoughts and conversations exciting and fun! Freedom is powerful, and it can change your life—if you understand the proper context. So, what is the freedom I'm talking about? I can break it down into three parts: debt, assets, and income.